Unit 4 — Ireland: Stories from the Island

Track E · Klasse 8 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can read a short narrative about Ireland and identify the speaker's perspective.*
- *I can use relative clauses (*who, which, that, where*).*
- *I can write a 120-word place-portrait of an English-speaking region.*

Lead-in I

Hawa's pen-pal Niamh lives in Galway, on the west coast of Ireland. Her e-mails are mostly about wind, music, and people who walk faster than they talk. Hawa printed one and read it aloud at the breakfast table. Her father said: "That's the kind of place where you'd lose three umbrellas in a week."

Reading I

Reading — *Niamh's letter from Galway*

Hi Hawa, today the wind tried to take my school bag along Salthill prom. I won. Galway is the kind of city where you can walk into a pub at lunchtime and find three musicians playing for the joy of it. My grandmother, who learned Irish (Gaeilge) as a first language, says the language is louder than ever. The shops where the staff speak only Irish are still rare, but they exist. I'll write more on Tuesday, which is when I'm meant to be doing homework but I'll probably write to you instead.

Grammar — relative clauses

who — for people: *My grandmother, who learned Irish, … which* — for things: *The wind, which is famous, … that* — people or things (informal): *The pub that has the best music … where* —

Reading II

places: *Galway is a city where …*
Defining (no commas) vs. non-defining (with commas): *The pub that has music* (defines which pub). *Galway, which is on the west coast, is famous for music* (extra info).

Practise I

Niveau E — controlled

1. Choose: *who, which, that, where*. The musicians _____ play in the pub. The wind ___ _____ took the bag. Galway is a place _____ the rain is constant.
2. Combine: *Niamh has a grandmother. She learned Irish.* → ___ .

Niveau E — productive

3. Build 4 sentences with one relative clause each (use *who, which, that, where*).

Your turn I

Place-portrait, 120 words. Write a short letter describing a place you know (or want to know) in an English-speaking country. Use 4 relative clauses.

Sample

Hi Niamh, I'd love to visit a place where the sea and the city sit next to each other — like your Galway. I want to find the pub that has music every lunchtime. My friend Jonas, who has been to Dublin twice, says the buses there are run by people who actually answer questions. I'd start with the Cliffs of Moher, which I have only seen on postcards. Then I'd ask your grandmother to teach me one Irish phrase, just one, that I could use every day.

Reflect I

- I can read a short Irish letter and find the speaker’s perspective.
- I can use relative clauses (who/which/that/where).
- I can write a 120-word place-portrait letter.

Further reading / listening I

- RTÉ Learning English — Ireland-focused content.
- Tourism Ireland — accessible articles for young learners.